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DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

PAKISTAN & THE WORLD

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THE LEAD / DEFENCE & REGIONAL SECURITY

Four States Sign Badr Defence-Industry Memorandum

Pakistan joined Qatar, Türkiye and Indonesia in a Doha agreement aimed at manufacturing cooperation, research and military training.

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AT A GLANCE

BADR MEMORANDUM

Pakistan, Qatar, Türkiye and Indonesia signed an industrial-defence cooperation framework in Doha.

SAVINGS RETURNS

Higher National Savings returns took effect across several targeted retail products.

UKRAINE DIPLOMACY

Moscow indicated conditional willingness to resume trilateral talks in November.

MALDIVES PARTNERSHIP

Islamabad and Malé exchanged twenty MoUs and adopted a $200 million trade objective.

CLIMATE WARNING

UNEP set out the steep emissions cuts required to minimise overshoot of 1.5°C.

THE REPORT

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, Pakistan, Qatar, Türkiye and Indonesia signed the Badr Memorandum of Understanding in Doha. Qatar News Agency described cooperation on defence manufacturing, research, technical training and capacity-building. Defence and industrial representatives of the four states participated.

Pakistan's Defence Minister Khawaja Muhammad Asif attended the signing. Official reporting presented Badr as a framework for pooling industrial capability and pursuing joint research. A memorandum does not itself establish a joint military command or automatic mutual-defence obligations.

BACKGROUND The memorandum was concluded amid greater attention to supply-chain security, strategic autonomy and the rising cost of imported defence technology. Its text and implementation timetable had not been published in the accessible announcements.

ANALYSIS Industrial cooperation can reduce reliance on a single external supplier and potentially improve access to technical expertise. It also creates obligations to manage licensing, sensitive technology and the end-use of jointly produced equipment. Pakistan can evaluate the pact by examining whether follow-on projects create local value, credible export prospects and sustained training capacity, rather than treating the signature itself as proof of operational capability.

REVISION 1. Four states signed Badr in Doha on 21 October. 2. The MoU covers production, research and training. 3. It creates no automatic collective-defence obligation.

CSS ANGLE International Relations — defence diplomacy and strategic autonomy [1] [2]

01 PAKISTAN

Foreign policy, governance, industrial choices and the domestic economy

SBP POLICY RATE 11.50% · latest policy, 14 Sep 2026 [23] KSE-100 CLOSE 165,930.98 · 21 Oct 2026 [24]

01 / FOREIGN POLICY | SOUTH ASIA

Pakistan and Maldives Exchange Twenty Cooperation MoUs

Bilateral trade, digital cooperation and maritime links featured in the visiting president's talks in Islamabad.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, Pakistani Prime Minister Muhammad Shehbaz Sharif and Maldivian President Dr Mohamed Muizzu witnessed the exchange of 20 memoranda of understanding in Islamabad. Official statements from both capitals confirmed the number and described cooperation in information technology, cyber security, health, education, tourism, agriculture, policing and other fields.

The leaders agreed to seek an increase in bilateral trade to $200 million within two years. The Maldivian presidency put the starting trade figure at $13 million, while Pakistan's official and news-agency statements used approximately $13.9 million; the variation reflects differing published baselines rather than two separate targets. Both sides also discussed connectivity and contacts between private-sector businesses.

The 20 documents are broad in subject matter. Some address people-to-people cooperation and institutional exchanges; others involve digital skills, innovation, narcotics-control cooperation and defence. These are useful legal and diplomatic starting points, but they do not establish that goods, investment flows or direct transport links will increase automatically.

President Muizzu's visit, scheduled for 20–22 October, came during the 60th anniversary year of diplomatic relations, established in 1966. The two governments presented the meetings as an opportunity to move beyond cordial declarations towards commercial activity and sector-specific institutional work.

BACKGROUND

Maldives is an Indian Ocean island state whose commerce and tourism depend heavily on maritime and air links. Cooperation with Islamabad takes place alongside Maldives' wider relationships with South Asian and other partners.

ANALYSIS

For Pakistan, practical opportunities lie in pharmaceuticals, education services, food products, skills and business travel. The leap from an approximately $13–14 million base to $200 million is ambitious; reaching it requires market access, trade facilitation and viable logistics. A meaningful evaluation must distinguish the target from measured export performance and signed documents from completed projects.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 Twenty MoUs were exchanged during talks on 21 October 2026.

02 The two governments stated a $200 million two-year trade objective.

03 Diplomatic relations were established in 1966; 2026 marks sixty years.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs — relations with the Indian Ocean region and economic diplomacy [3] [4] [33]

02 / PUBLIC FINANCE | HOUSEHOLD SAVINGS

National Savings Raises Returns on Major Schemes

Revised rates took effect on 21 October, with pensioner and welfare-linked schemes receiving higher annual returns.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, revised profit rates became effective across several National Savings products. The Central Directorate of National Savings listed Behbood Savings Certificates, Pensioners' Benefit Accounts and Shuhada Family Welfare Accounts at 12.96 percent per annum, up from 12.72 percent. The official schedule presents a monthly profit of Rs1,080 per Rs100,000 invested for the relevant welfare products.

Regular Income Certificates increased to 12.12 percent from 11.76 percent, equivalent to Rs1,010 per month for every Rs100,000 at the published rate. Special Savings products also rose under their specified profit-payment schedule. Ordinary savings accounts remained at 10 percent annually. Tax and Zakat treatment depends on the applicable rules and investor category.

The change alters expected returns for households using state-administered instruments. It can be significant for people who depend on monthly investment income, particularly pensioners and families using special-purpose schemes. The headline annual rate should not be confused with the amount a saver receives after statutory withholding and other deductions.

The Directorate publishes distinct products with different maturity, payment frequency and eligibility features. Comparing them only by their annual percentages conceals differences in liquidity, taxation and the timing of cash flows. Revised nominal returns also cannot by themselves show whether savers gain purchasing power after inflation.

BACKGROUND

National Savings instruments are part of government debt mobilisation from retail investors. Rates may change as financing conditions and policy settings shift; they are different from the State Bank's monetary policy rate.

ANALYSIS

Higher returns support some household incomes but can also increase the government's cost of borrowing. The distributional effect depends on who holds the certificates and whether investors have access to alternative instruments. Public-finance analysis must compare nominal returns with inflation, tax treatment and fiscal cost before inferring a benefit to all savers.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 Behbood, Pensioners' Benefit and Shuhada schemes: 12.96% from 21 October.

02 Regular Income Certificates: 12.12%; ordinary Savings Account: 10%.

03 Published returns are product-specific and may be reduced by applicable deductions.

CSS ANGLE Economy — domestic debt, savings instruments and monetary transmission [5] [6]

03 / INDUSTRIAL POLICY | AUTOMOTIVE

Draft Auto Policy Sets Export and EV Incentive Goals

The proposed 2026–31 framework seeks a larger export base but still requires formal approval.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, detailed reporting disclosed the draft Auto Policy 2026–31 after Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif gave it in-principle approval on Tuesday. The proposal targets approximately $6

billion in five-year automotive exports and includes changes to import tariffs, export obligations and taxation for different electric-vehicle categories.

The draft envisages tariff reductions towards an average of 15 percent, a 1 percent sales tax on battery electric vehicles, higher specified rates for some hybrid categories and an Automotive Development Levy intended to generate about Rs232 billion over five years. Export incentives and local parts development are presented as important elements of the proposed system.

Government sources cited in the reports said the draft must proceed through cabinet and parliamentary stages. Consequently the proposed rates and targets should not be treated as operative law. Industry voices differed: proponents stressed competitiveness and export capacity, while representatives of parts manufacturers warned that lower import protection might weaken domestic suppliers.

The policy debate is about the direction of industrial development. Manufacturers want predictable rules and adequate scale; consumers value affordability and quality; the government seeks tax receipts, jobs and foreign exchange. These objectives can collide if tariff adjustments are made without evidence on the capacity of local suppliers to adapt.

BACKGROUND

Pakistan's vehicle sector has relied on tariff and localisation arrangements. The new draft attempts to shift incentives towards export performance and technology, including electric mobility.

ANALYSIS

The test of the plan is implementation. A nominal export target does not ensure overseas buyers, product standards or cost competitiveness. A credible transition would publish the final tariff schedule, define independent performance reviews and offer time-bound support for competitive local components rather than permanent protection or abrupt exposure.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 The proposal covers 2026–31 and remains a draft, not enacted policy.

02 Reported five-year export ambition is approximately $6 billion.

03 A proposed 1% battery-EV sales-tax rate is not an already implemented tax change.

CSS ANGLE Economy — protectionism, export diversification and the energy transition [7] [8]

04 / GOVERNANCE | JUDICIAL REVIEW

Peshawar High Court Orders Residence Provisionally Unsealed

The interim decision restrained the arrest of the KP Assembly deputy speaker while the court sought official responses.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, the Peshawar High Court directed the provisional de-sealing of the official residence of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Assembly Deputy Speaker Suraiya Bibi and restrained police from arresting her under Section 3 of the Maintenance of Public Order Ordinance until further orders.

The two-member bench, comprising Justice Ijaz Anwar and Justice Muhammad Faheem Wali, heard a petition challenging the residence's sealing and the possibility of preventive detention. The petitioner's counsel argued that her office and residence rights continued notwithstanding the emergency arrangements introduced in the province earlier in October.

The court sought responses from provincial authorities, including senior administrative and police officials. This was interim judicial protection while the petition remained under consideration. Reports did not describe

the court as having finally determined all constitutional questions about the emergency, the office or the underlying detention powers.

The case places administrative action against an elected officeholder before judicial scrutiny. It turns attention to the requirement that executive restrictions have a recognisable legal basis and remain reviewable by a court.

BACKGROUND

The case arose after governor's rule and emergency measures were imposed in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa on 11 October. Earlier actions are relevant background, but the judicial directions being reported were made on 21 October.

ANALYSIS

An interim order matters because it preserves a position while litigation proceeds; it does not resolve the merits. The constitutional question is how lawful public-order measures can be distinguished from arbitrary interference in representative institutions. The government's response and the eventual written orders will be important for a final legal assessment.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 The Peshawar High Court issued interim directions on 21 October.

02 It required provisional access to the residence and restrained arrest under Section 3 MPO.

03 Notices were issued to officials; the dispute remained pending.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs — emergency powers, rule of law and provincial autonomy [9] [10]

05 / ENERGY | CONSUMER PRICES

Government Announces New Petrol and Diesel Rates

An October 21 notification changed pump prices from the following day amid daily fuel repricing.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, the government announced a petroleum-price revision to take effect on Thursday, 22 October. Petrol was reduced by Rs2.71 per litre to Rs379.31, while high-speed diesel was increased by Rs0.31 per litre to Rs390.11. These figures refer to the newly notified effective date, not the previous day's pump prices.

The published sequence of daily changes means an analyst must distinguish the announcement date, the date a price takes legal effect and the price it replaces. The preceding 21 October rates were Rs382.02 per litre for petrol and Rs389.80 for diesel. Different reports may describe the same decision as an October 21 announcement or an October 22 price.

Petrol and diesel prices matter through different channels. Petrol affects urban commuting and private transport, while high-speed diesel is an important cost for freight, agriculture and generators. A small change in one product does not imply an equal change across the cost of living.

The authorities linked the revision to movements in international pricing benchmarks and related supply costs. The published retail price is the final notified outcome; understanding its drivers requires separating the underlying product price from transport charges, taxes and other adjustments.

BACKGROUND

Pakistan has used frequent petroleum-price notifications during sustained international energy-market volatility. Changes in global supply risks can transmit quickly into domestic costs.

ANALYSIS

Pricing transparency is as important as the direction of any individual movement. Citizens and firms need clear effective dates, consistent reporting of levies and predictable procedures. For energy-security policy, the wider questions

	concern import dependence, fuel efficiency, competition, storage and alternatives to costly liquid fuels.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 On 21 October, a revision was announced for 22 October.

02 New petrol price: Rs379.31/litre; new high-speed diesel: Rs390.11/litre.

03 Changes from the preceding rates: petrol −Rs2.71, diesel +Rs0.31.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs — inflation, energy security and fiscal levies [11] [12]

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02 WORLD

Climate, multilateral economic governance and international security

01 / CLIMATE POLICY | GLOBAL

UNEP Warns of Larger Climate Overshoot

The 2026 Emissions Gap Report found that stated climate commitments remain far below the cuts required for a low-overshoot pathway.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, the UN Environment Programme released its Emissions Gap Report 2026, titled The Point of Return. It assessed a pathway in which warming temporarily exceeds the Paris Agreement's 1.5°C benchmark, peaks near 1.7–1.8°C around mid-century and could return towards 1.5°C by 2100 with roughly an even chance.

According to UNEP, that pathway requires greenhouse-gas emissions to fall 18 percent below 2025 levels by 2030, 45 percent by 2035 and 69 percent by 2040, along with increasingly significant carbon removal later in the century. Existing national commitments fall well short of those requirements.

The report separates what is physically modelled from what countries have pledged or implemented. The lowest-overshoot case is not a forecast that the world will achieve the outcome. It is a stringent scenario contingent on strong near-term reductions and additional measures whose feasibility is uncertain.

Although renewable deployment and some policies are cutting emissions, UNEP described the scale and timing of global reductions as inadequate. The central policy problem is the distance between actual trajectories and pathways consistent with international climate goals.

BACKGROUND

The Paris Agreement seeks to hold warming well below 2°C and pursue efforts to limit it to 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels. Overshoot refers to temporarily exceeding a threshold before subsequently returning below it.

ANALYSIS

For Pakistan, already vulnerable to floods, heat stress and water-related shocks, the findings strengthen the case for adaptation finance and resilient infrastructure, but the report does not replace country-level attribution studies. The strategic task is to connect domestic development planning with credible adaptation measures while pressing for transparent global mitigation commitments.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 UNEP released the Emissions Gap Report 2026 on 21 October.

02 Lowest-overshoot scenario peak: about 1.7–1.8°C near mid-century.

03 Required cuts from 2025 emissions: 18% by 2030 and 45% by 2035.

CSS ANGLE Environmental Science — climate mitigation, adaptation and climate justice [13] [14] [35]

02 / REGIONAL ECONOMY | ASIA-PACIFIC

APEC Finance Ministers Back Greater Economic Coordination

A joint statement in Hong Kong prioritised households, digital infrastructure and access to finance.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, finance ministers and officials from Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation economies issued a joint statement after meeting in Hong Kong on 20–21 October. The 33rd annual ministerial meeting was chaired by Chinese Finance Minister Lan Fo'an.

The statement identified four cooperation areas: fiscal support for households, financing digital infrastructure, broadening financial access and dialogue with young financial talent. It endorsed a policy statement on digital-infrastructure finance based on voluntary approaches to mobilising investment.

Participants stressed credible and flexible fiscal, monetary and financial frameworks as tools for managing external shocks. Their statement reflected pressures from geopolitical uncertainty, debt, weak demand in some economies and rapid technological change. It did not create a supranational fiscal authority or impose a uniform economic programme on member economies.

APEC is an economic cooperation forum rather than a treaty-based customs union. Its work is influential through policy coordination and business networks, but the outcomes should be assessed as voluntary commitments rather than automatically enforceable rules.

BACKGROUND

APEC was formed in 1989 to strengthen economic cooperation across the Asia-Pacific. Its members are described as economies, reflecting the forum's trade and investment focus.

ANALYSIS

The Hong Kong agenda shows that trade policy alone cannot address growth constraints. Payments systems, digital infrastructure and household resilience shape productivity and market participation. Pakistan is not an APEC member, but supply-chain and investment decisions in the region affect its prospects for exports, logistics and technological upgrading.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 APEC finance ministers met in Hong Kong on 20–21 October.

02 The session was the forum's 33rd annual finance ministerial meeting.

03 Four priorities included household fiscal support and digital-infrastructure financing.

CSS ANGLE International Relations — regional economic integration and institutions [15] [16]

03 / PUBLIC HEALTH | CLIMATE

WHO Partners Launch Extreme-Heat Health Indicators

A global framework seeks comparable monitoring of harm to pregnant women, newborns and children.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, WHO, the World Meteorological Organization, UNICEF and the United Nations Population Fund launched a joint framework of priority indicators to monitor the effects of extreme heat on maternal, newborn and child health.

The framework recommends monitoring outcomes such as preterm births, stillbirths, low birthweight, pregnancy-related hypertension, child deaths and health-facility visits alongside heat exposure. It also points to school attendance as a possible way to understand disruptions affecting children.

WHO cited research linking heat exposure to a 26 percent increase in the odds of preterm birth and estimated that 1.5 billion children encounter heatwaves whose frequency, duration or intensity is increasing. Such findings describe broad evidence and exposure patterns; they are not a count of individual deaths attributable to one day of heat.

The new indicators span routine health services, surveillance, climate monitoring and the measurement of exposure. Their use could improve early warnings and decisions about facility staffing, care protocols, outreach and protection for groups less able to avoid harmful conditions.

BACKGROUND

Public-health systems have often monitored heat as a meteorological event but have lacked consistent links to maternal and child clinical outcomes. Comparable indicators can improve planning without treating correlation as proof of causation in every case.

ANALYSIS

This is an institutional rather than purely scientific intervention. Better local data can connect health budgets, emergency management, urban planning and climate adaptation. In Pakistan, credible applications would require reliable patient records, weather observations and confidentiality safeguards, rather than assuming that a global framework automatically produces national surveillance capacity.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 The framework was launched on 21 October by WHO, WMO, UNICEF and UNFPA.

02 It joins clinical outcomes with measurements of extreme-heat exposure.

03 WHO cited an estimated 1.5 billion children facing worsening heatwaves.

CSS ANGLE Environmental Science — heat-related risks and climate-sensitive health policy [17] [18]

04 / EU ECONOMY | CLIMATE REGULATION

EU Negotiators Announce Carbon-Reserve Compromise

A proposed higher threshold would retain more emissions allowances in reserve, pending formal legislative approval.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, the Council of the European Union publicly announced that it and the European Parliament had reached a provisional agreement the day before on the EU Emissions Trading System's market stability reserve. The proposal would change how surplus emissions allowances are permanently cancelled.

The agreement retains an invalidation mechanism but proposes lifting its threshold from 400 million to 700 million allowances after adoption. The Council explained that a larger retained stock could improve the system's capacity to respond to future market shortages and volatile allowance prices.

The change had not yet become law. The Council and Parliament still needed to endorse the arrangement and complete formal adoption. Nor does keeping allowances in the reserve amount to an immediate release into the trading market. The distinction between available stocks, reserve holdings and cancelled units is essential for accurate carbon-market analysis.

Under emissions trading, regulated firms must obtain and surrender allowances corresponding to their covered emissions. An emissions cap constrains the system overall; the stability reserve is intended to moderate imbalances between allowance supply and demand.

BACKGROUND

The EU ETS is a cap-and-trade system. Its reserve can absorb surplus allowances and, under specified conditions, release them; the invalidation rule determines when some reserve holdings cease to exist.

ANALYSIS

The compromise illustrates a persistent regulatory tension: high carbon prices encourage cleaner production, while sharp volatility can undermine industrial planning and political support. Pakistan's exporters may face increasingly complex carbon-related requirements in overseas markets; understanding the difference between climate ambition and

market design is therefore relevant even outside the EU.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 Agreement announced 21 October concerned a deal reached 20 October.

02 Proposed invalidation threshold: 700 million, up from 400 million allowances.

03 The amendment remained provisional; it was not yet in force.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs — emissions trading, carbon pricing and climate diplomacy [19] [20]

05 / DIPLOMACY | EUROPEAN SECURITY

Moscow Signals Openness to Renewed Ukraine Talks

Russian and American envoys discussed possible negotiations, while a final settlement remained distant.

On Wednesday, 21 October 2026, Kremlin foreign-policy aide Yuri Ushakov said President Vladimir Putin was willing in principle to restart talks with Ukraine and the United States in November. The comments followed Putin's meeting with US envoy Steve Witkoff in St Petersburg.

Reuters reported that the parties discussed possible post-war security arrangements. The Associated Press said the proposed discussions could take place after 10 November, while Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy expressed support for renewed negotiations. Previous trilateral rounds earlier in 2026 had produced little publicly reported progress towards resolving the war.

Willingness to negotiate is a diplomatic development, not evidence of a ceasefire. The governments continue to disagree over territorial and security terms. Reports of parallel discussions about economic cooperation cannot substitute for a documented settlement on the conflict's central issues.

The timing matters because new talks can influence expectations about sanctions, energy markets and European security. Their prospects depend on whether mediators and the parties can agree on an agenda, enforcement arrangements and the relationship between a ceasefire and any durable political settlement.

BACKGROUND

Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine began in February 2022. Prior rounds of talks have faced sustained disagreements on sovereignty, territory and long-term security guarantees.

ANALYSIS

This development is best read as a diplomatic opening with substantial uncertainty. A framework that lacks monitoring, enforceable commitments and an acceptable political basis may not survive first contact with unresolved military objectives. Pakistan's interest lies in the effects on global energy prices, food markets, multilateral institutions and respect for territorial sovereignty.

THREE REVISION POINTS

01 Kremlin aide Yuri Ushakov discussed renewed talks on 21 October 2026.

02 The proposed format involves Russia, Ukraine and the United States.

03 No ceasefire or peace agreement was announced.

CSS ANGLE International Relations — conflict resolution, mediation and European security [21] [22]

NEXT SEVEN DAYS

22 OCT Maldives–Pakistan Business Forum anticipated as part of President Muizzu's visit. [33]

23 OCT EU press briefing ahead of Agriculture and Fisheries Council. [34]

26–27 OCT EU Agriculture and Fisheries Council scheduled in Luxembourg. [34]

27–28 OCT US Federal Open Market Committee meeting scheduled. [32]

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03 GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

Nineteen high-yield facts with source references

01 DEFENCE

The Badr memorandum was signed in Doha on 21 October 2026. [1]

02 DEFENCE

Four states signed Badr: Pakistan, Qatar, Türkiye and Indonesia. [2]

03 DIPLOMACY

Pakistan and Maldives exchanged 20 MoUs on 21 October 2026. [3]

04 DIPLOMACY

Pakistan and Maldives marked 60 years of diplomatic relations in 2026. [4]

05 ECONOMY

Pakistan–Maldives bilateral trade target: $200 million within two years. [3]

06 SAVINGS

Behbood and Pensioners' Benefit rates reached 12.96% effective 21 October. [5]

07 SAVINGS

Regular Income Certificates returned 12.12% under the revised schedule. [5]

08 SAVINGS

Ordinary National Savings accounts remained at 10% per annum. [5]

09 INDUSTRY

The proposed Auto Policy is for the period 2026–31. [7]

10 INDUSTRY

The draft automotive policy reports an export ambition near $6 billion. [8]

11 GOVERNANCE

The Peshawar High Court's interim directions concerned the KP Assembly deputy speaker. [9]

12 GOVERNANCE

Section 3 of the Maintenance of Public Order Ordinance featured in the petition. [10]

13 ENERGY

New petrol price effective 22 October: Rs379.31 per litre. [11]

14 CLIMATE

UNEP's 2026 low-overshoot scenario peaks near 1.7–1.8°C. [13]

15 CLIMATE

UNEP specifies an 18% emissions cut by 2030 from 2025 levels for that pathway. [13]

16 ECONOMY

APEC held its 33rd annual finance ministers' meeting in Hong Kong. [16]

17 HEALTH

WHO's heat-health indicators span four monitoring domains. [18]

18 EUROPE

The proposed EU ETS reserve threshold is 700 million allowances. [19]

19 DIPLOMACY

Moscow signalled openness to renewed trilateral Ukraine talks in November. [21]

04 FIVE TERMS

Enduring concepts across political science, diplomacy, economy, law and environment

01 Bicameralism

A bicameral legislature has two separate chambers that take part in lawmaking. Their composition and powers differ according to a country's constitution.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters because legislation and federal representation often depend on the relationship between two houses.

EXAMPLE Pakistan's 1973 Constitution provides for the National Assembly and the Senate as two parliamentary houses under Article 50. [26]

02 Diplomatic Immunity

Diplomatic immunity refers to legal protections granted to accredited diplomatic agents under international diplomatic law. These protections help missions perform official duties independently of the receiving state's ordinary coercive processes.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters for sovereignty, state responsibility and the management of bilateral diplomatic disputes.

EXAMPLE The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations was concluded in Vienna on 18 April 1961 and entered into force in 1964. [27]

03 Purchasing Power Parity

Purchasing power parities are conversion factors that compare the price levels of a comparable basket of goods and services across economies. They allow comparisons of real economic output that do not depend solely on market exchange rates.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters when interpreting comparative GDP, income and living-standard statistics.

EXAMPLE The World Bank's International Comparison Program used 2021 as a reference year for a major global comparison. [28]

04 Mandamus

A writ of mandamus is a court order directing a public authority or lower tribunal to perform a legally required duty. It is an extraordinary remedy, normally used where ordinary alternatives are insufficient.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters for administrative accountability and remedies against unlawful inaction.

EXAMPLE In Marbury v. Madison (1803), William Marbury sought a writ of mandamus concerning a judicial commission. [29]

05 El Niño–Southern Oscillation

ENSO is a recurring pattern of changes in equatorial Pacific sea-surface temperatures and atmospheric circulation. Its warm phase is El Niño, its cool phase is La Niña, and both can influence rainfall and temperature far beyond the Pacific.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters for seasonal forecasting, food security, drought management and disaster preparedness.

EXAMPLE NOAA documented an exceptionally strong El Niño episode in 1997–98, followed by La Niña conditions during 1998. [30]

05 PRACTICE

Fifteen independently sourced objective questions

Q01 Which city hosted the Badr memorandum signing?

A. Ankara
B. Doha
C. Jakarta
D. Islamabad

Q02 How many governments joined the Badr memorandum?

A. Three
B. Five
C. Four
D. Six

Q03 How many MoUs were exchanged between Pakistan and Maldives?

A. 20
B. 12
C. 16
D. 24

Q04 The Pakistan–Maldives trade target announced on 21 October was:

A. $100 million
B. $150 million
C. $250 million
D. $200 million

Q05 The revised Behbood Savings Certificate rate was:

A. 12.72%
B. 12.96%
C. 11.76%
D. 12.12%

Q06 Pakistan's proposed Auto Policy covers which years?

A. 2024–29
B. 2025–30
C. 2026–31
D. 2027–32

Q07 Which institution ordered provisional de-sealing of the KP deputy speaker's residence?

A. Peshawar High Court
B. Federal Shariat Court
C. Supreme Court
D. Islamabad High Court

Q08 Which fuel rose in the price revision announced on 21 October?

A. Petrol
B. Kerosene
C. Light diesel
D. High-speed diesel

Q09 UNEP's lowest-overshoot scenario projects peak warming of approximately:

A. 1.0–1.2°C
B. 1.7–1.8°C
C. 2.4–2.5°C
D. 3.0–3.2°C

Q10 The APEC finance ministers' meeting concluded in:

A. Seoul
B. Bangkok
C. Hong Kong
D. Singapore

Q11 Which pair of agencies participated in the WHO heat-health indicator framework?

A. WMO and UNICEF
B. WTO and UNESCO
C. FAO and IAEA
D. UNHCR and IMO

Q12 The proposed EU ETS reserve invalidation threshold is:

A. 300 million
B. 500 million
C. 900 million
D. 700 million

Q13 Which benchmark is used for UNEP's specified 2030 emissions reduction?

A. 2019 emissions
B. 2025 emissions
C. 2015 emissions
D. 2020 emissions

Q14 The proposed new Ukraine talks discussed on 21 October involve:

A. Ukraine, Poland and Russia
B. Russia, Türkiye and EU
C. Russia, Ukraine and US
D. US, China and NATO

Q15 Which mechanism was at issue in the EU carbon-market provisional agreement?

A. Market stability reserve
B. Carbon border registry
C. Energy solidarity fund
D. Common emissions levy

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05 ANSWER KEY

Correct options with brief reasons and primary references

01 B — The four-country defence-industry memorandum was signed in Doha.[1]

02 C — Pakistan, Qatar, Türkiye and Indonesia were the four parties.[1]

03 A — The two governments confirmed exchange of 20 memoranda.[3]

04 D — The two leaders set a target of $200 million in two years.[3]

05 B — The revised rate for Behbood and certain welfare instruments was 12.96%.[5]

06 C — The disclosed policy draft covers 2026 through 2031.[7]

07 A — The Peshawar High Court issued interim directions on 21 October.[9]

08 D — High-speed diesel rose by Rs0.31 while petrol fell by Rs2.71.[11]

09 B — The 2026 UNEP report assessed a 1.7–1.8°C mid-century peak.[13]

10 C — The meeting concluded in Hong Kong on 21 October.[15]

11 A — WMO and UNICEF worked with WHO and UNFPA on the framework.[17]

12 D — EU negotiators proposed 700 million allowances, up from 400 million.[19]

13 B — UNEP called for 18% cuts by 2030 relative to 2025 emissions.[13]

14 C — The renewed format discussed was Russia, Ukraine and the United States.[21]

15 A — Negotiators addressed invalidation of allowances held in the market stability reserve.[19]

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06 REFERENCES

Official releases, institutional records and independent reporting

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